Nobody in the SIT could understand what the hurry was in raiding the house without informing the tracking team. The tracking team arrived in Muthati and Biroota just as the boys were dying. No administration of an antidote helped. The team also did not find anything significant, but the police had traced the address of Ranganath's house. His antecedents were still unclear—the only thing they knew was that it was he who had taken the house on rent. Instead of going to that address and catching Ranganath, the police passed on the address to the office of the director general of police, Karnataka.

The next morning all newspapers had carried news of the raid and suicides on their front pages, and questions were again raised about the efficiency of the SIT. But of the three arrested from the raid, Dhanasekaran was a prized catch. Even though there was still no sign of Sivarasan, Dhanasekaran admitted that the mastermind had travelled to Bangalore in his oil tanker.

Ranganath had gone to buy milk for his guests in Konanakunte. The newspapers on display in the stall caught his attention. He bought copies and showed them to Sivarasan. Tension was writ large on all their faces; Sivarasan looked desperate. He said, 'The dogs of the CBI are everywhere. They will come here too.' Then he turned to look at Ranganath, as if expecting an answer from him. Mridula suddenly had an attack of asthma and fell to the floor, but she gathered herself and wanted to go out of the house for some fresh air. But Sivarasan blocked her way and threatened her. She didn't care. Everyone was shocked at her guts. Ranganath swung into action. He pleaded with Sivarasan not to get angry. He said he would take his wife to a doctor and come back with her soon.

It was clear to Ranganath that the police would be reaching his house in Putanahally soon. The first thing he checked with his wife was if she had been feigning the asthma attack in front of Sivarasan. He had to plan his next moves accordingly—whether to take her to a doctor or head home. Mridula wanted to go back home. The couple rushed home, picked up their